

AI Learning about Game Design

- Game design compiles psychology, storytelling, art, and systems thinking to engage players.
- Create a meaningful experience for the player.

1. Player-Centered Design

- i. How should the player feel
- ii. Is the game intuitive/confusing
- iii. Is it fun/frustrating
- iv. Playtesting is important

2. Create a Core Gameplay Loop

- i. Example: Action → Reward → Upgrade → Repeat
- ii. Good loops keep players engaged
 - a. simple, but fun to repeat

3. Balance

- i. Unfair is not fun
- ii. Difficulty vs. unfairness
- iii. Too easy creates boredom
- iv. Flow is boredom vs. frustration

4. Clear goals and Feedback

- i. players need some direction
 - a. How well they are doing
- ii. Feedback examples:
 - a. sound effects
 - b. visual cues
 - c. progress indicators

5. Meaningful choices

- i. trade-offs - gain one thing, lose another
- ii. multiple strategies
- iii. choices that affect the outcome

6. Progression and rewards

- i. Examples: Levels, skills, upgrades, better gear, narrative progression

7. simplicity

- i. easy to learn, but still has depth

8. Immersive

- i. cohesive theming

Game Design tips I received:

1. Be wary of repeating commands

- i. Tedious

- ii. Some solutions:

- a. Scripts/Macros/Aliases to shorten user input. Also command history

- b. Make commands more expressive

- c. Create pressure

2. Make the learning of the language fun
3. Reward for creative use of commands
4. Good Feedback
 - i. Make sure to have visual and/or audible feedback
5. Add Variant loops
 - i. Combat that focuses on fast decisions
 - ii. Exploration
 - iii. Puzzles
 - iv. Have resource management

1. Narrative reason for the command line
2. Decide whether the game should be fast or slow paced
3. Suggestion given: command chaining

I asked about a way to make the combat to be more interesting

1. change commands from move, attack to dash, lunge, circle enemy, rush, retreat, guard
 - i. decrease typing and increase meaning
2. Intent based combat
 - i. decision making instead of just typing fast

3. commands should persist, not be one off
 - i. define behavior
 - ii. have commands last for a duration
 - iii. otherwise players will spam
4. Cooldown/commitment
5. Enemies should demand different commands to defeat